



14 questions to ask a university before you pay the deposit

Deposits are almost never refundable. Ask these in writing — and keep the reply

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Almost everywhere the deposit is non-refundable: it counts towards tuition, but you do not get it back if you change your mind or your visa is refused. So ask the questions below **before** paying — and always by email, so the answer stays on record.

About the programme

- **What language is the whole programme taught in?** Not "taught in English", but what share of courses is in English and which subjects are in the local language. On medical programmes, ask specifically about clinical rotations in the later years.
- **Is this programme accredited, not only the university?** Ask for the name of the body and a link to the register. For North Cyprus this is the decisive question: programmes outside the YÖK list are not considered for degree recognition.
- **Who awards the degree?** At branch campuses the degree is normally awarded by the home university — ask them to confirm that in writing.
- **How long is the programme including any foundation year?** A foundation or language year adds a year to both the timeline and the budget.

About money

- **What is the price for my intake year?** A 2026/27 price list is not a 2027/28 price list.

- **Is the fee fixed for the whole degree or reviewed every year?**
 - **What is not included in tuition?** Registration fee, insurance, labs, exams, ID card, accommodation, taxes.
 - **How is the deposit credited, and when is it refunded?** Ask separately about visa refusal: for some universities this is the only refundable case, and it comes with conditions and deadlines.
 - **Which discounts apply and how are they kept?** Nationality, upfront payment and exam-score discounts usually require a minimum GPA to be renewed.
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About entry and status

- **Who files the visa or entry permit application — the university or me?** In some countries only the university can apply.
 - **Can I apply for a residence permit after entering visa-free or on an e-Visa, or do I need a student visa?** Requirements differ between universities in the same country.
 - **Which documents must be legalised by registration day, and what happens if the procedure is not finished in time?**
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About life and support

- **Is there campus accommodation and is a place guaranteed for the first year?** If not, what do rooms near campus cost?
 - **Who is my contact in the international office and how fast do they reply?** Save the name and the email address.
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Red flags

- The university says the price will be "confirmed later" but asks for the deposit now.
 - Answers arrive only through a messenger from an intermediary, never from the university's own domain.
 - The programme cannot be found in the official accreditation register.
 - Guaranteed admission or a guaranteed visa is promised.
 - Payment is requested to a personal card, in crypto, or through a third party.
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What to do with the answers

Keep the correspondence in one email thread or a single PDF. If the terms change later, a written answer from the university is the only thing you can point to.

We can ask these questions with you. Send us the university and programme name — we will cross-check the answers against official registers and tell you where the wording differs from the record. The first

consultation is free. AcademGo office: Warsaw, ul. Złota 7/28.

Free AcademGo consultation: we ask these questions with you

AcademGo — study abroad consultancy. All figures come from official university and government sources; check the year of the price list before you pay.